of nationalism? Are matters of national security best left to the state, no matter what its character? Do we seriously believe any government can bring about a lasting solution to the Kashmir question if only Geelani keeps quiet and we refuse to raise awkward questions?

Only when we have real democracy in India can we expect others to respect us.

January 2004

***

Postscript, 25 November 2006

On 8 February 2005, there was an attempt to assassinate S.A.R. Geelani. Someone tried to kill him right outside my home. Within a few hours the news spread and his students, colleagues, friends, civil liberty activists and other concerned citizens gathered outside the hospital. So did the media. Restless with the waiting as Geelani was being operated upon, the media asked for reactions. Who could have shot Geelani? Without exception everyone responded: 'Special Cell, Delhi Police.'

There was good reason to suspect the Special Cell, because no one else could have known that we had decided to meet at my house that night. In fact, after the day's hearing at the Supreme Court we had decided we would not meet and he went to take classes and I went home to prepare for the next day. But suddenly I realized I needed to ask him some questions and phoned around five in the evening to ask whether he could come over on his way back from college. He arrived at 8.45 p.m. He parked his car and was checking whether the car doors were locked when he saw a man raise his hand and fire.

The police desperately tried to put out various theories on the assassination attempt. These included: road rage (no details given), an irate lover (never named), Naga insurgents (including my husband who is a Naga), a Kashmiri militant (one was arrested and tortured and when he refused to confess that he had tried to assassinate Geelani he was booked under the Official Secrets Act and is in jail). Very few noticed a story from an unnamed source in a Hindi newspaper. The story was that the intelligence agencies had used the services of the Chhota Rajan gang for the assassination. But who was going to ensure